



Tooth Morphology + Anticipatory Guidance

OMFS 721 – Pediatric Dentistry

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Mission: To advance the science and art of health through education, service, scholarship and social accountability

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Quiz Time!

What are we covering today?

- Primary tooth morphology basics (plus some tips and tricks)
- Anticipatory guidance fundamentals
- We will eventually be incorporating everything together to really understand how anticipatory guidance works

General Trends in Teeth

- Lower teeth usually comes in first
 - Exfoliation typically **follows the order** primary teeth came in
 - Also true of speed: if teeth come *in* earlier then they fall *out* earlier
- One side may develop faster than the other
- **Rule of 6's**
 - Every **six years** a new permanent molar erupts
 - Useful goalposts for tooth eruption dates

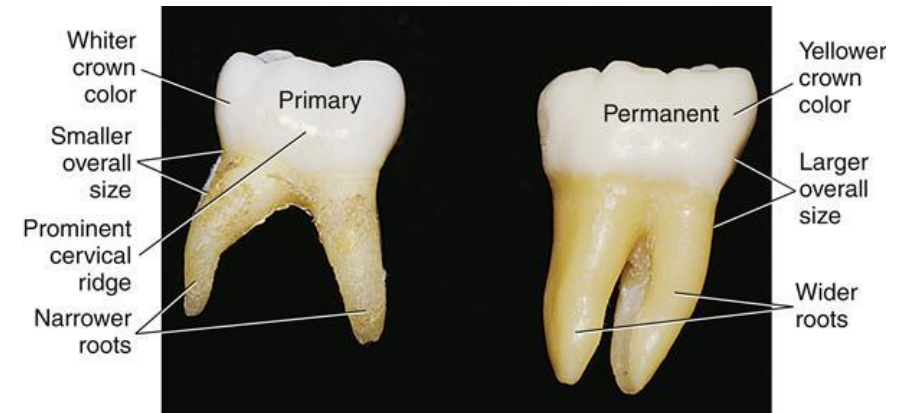
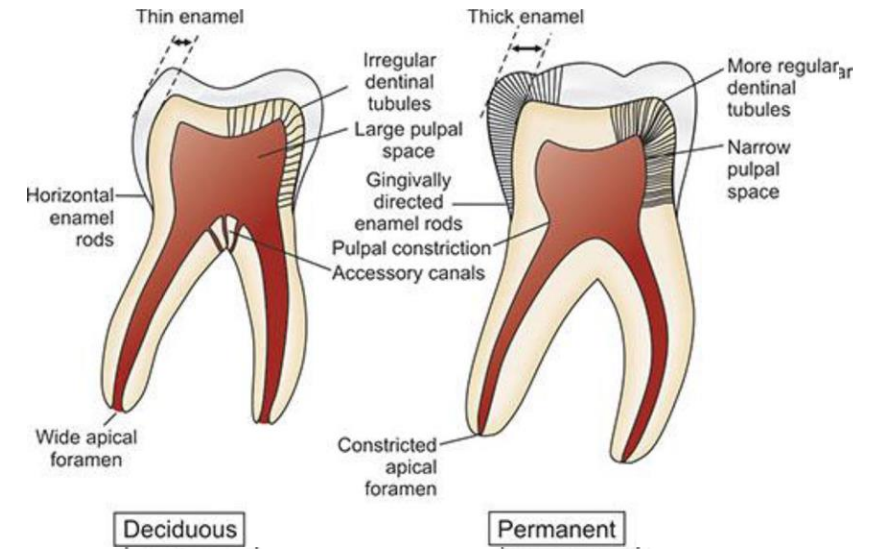
Primary Tooth Morphology

- Primary teeth are smaller and rounder
 - Contacts are wider/broader
- Less enamel
 - ...but also less dentin
 - Teeth are more translucent and whiter



Primary Molars

- Large pulp chamber and horns
 - More likely to pulp out
- Pulp chamber usually has multiple accessory canals
 - Pulpotomy effective!
- Roots are usually flared outwards
 - Room for permanent teeth to develop and erupt
 - Makes extractions challenging



Recognizing primary vs. permanent teeth



Primary Tooth Eruption

Primary Dentition						
	Calcification begins at	Formation complete at	Eruption		Exfoliation	
			Maxillary	Mandibular	Maxillary	Mandibular
Central incisors	4 th fetal mo	18-24 mo	6-10 mo	5-8 mo	7-8 y	6-7 y
Lateral incisors	4 th fetal mo	18-24 mo	8-12 mo	7-10 mo	8-9 y	7-8 y
Canines	4 th fetal mo	30-39 mo	16-20 mo	16-20 mo	11-12 y	9-11 y
First molars	4 th fetal mo	24-30 mo	11-18 mo	11-18 mo	9-11 y	10-12 y
Second molars	4 th fetal mo	36 mo	20-30 mo	20-30 mo	9-12 y	11-13 y

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Second molars	4 th fetal mo	36 mo	20-30 mo	20-30 mo	9-12 y	11-13 y

Usually, having all primary anteriors at ~12mo is a reasonable assumption to make
Recall: what is the AAPD criteria for establishing a dental home?

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“Last to come in, last to go”

Permanent Tooth Eruption

- Roots typically complete ~3 years after eruption of the tooth
- Crown completes in half the time of eruption date

Permanent Dentition					
	Calcification begins at	Crown (enamel) complete at	Roots complete at	Eruption*	
				Maxillary	Mandibular
Central incisors	3-4 mo	4-5 y	9-10 y	7-8 y (3)	6-7 y (2)
Lateral incisors	Maxilla: 10-12 mo Mandible: 3-4 mo	4-5 y 4-5 y	11 y 10 y	8-9 y (5)	7-8 y (4)
Canines	4-5 mo	6-7 y	12-15 y	11-12 y (11)	9-11 y (6)
First premolars	18-24 mo	5-6 y	12-13 y	10-11 y (7)	10-12 y (8)
Second premolars	24-30 mo	6-7 y	12-14 y	10-12 y (9)	11-13 y (10)
First molars	Birth	30-36 mo	9-10 y	5.5-7 y (1)	5.5-7 y (1a)
Second molars	30-36 mo	7-8 y	14-16 y	12-14 y (12)	12-14 y (12a)
Third molars	Maxilla: 7-9 y Mandible: 8-10 y			17-30 y (13)	17-30 y (13a)

Permanent Tooth Eruption

Typically, the highlighted teeth begin forming at birth

More susceptible to enamel hypoplasia

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Permanent Tooth Eruption (Rule of 6's)

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Anticipatory Guidance



Anticipatory Guidance

- Definition: the process of providing **practical and developmentally-appropriate** information about children's health to prepare parents for significant physical, emotional, and psychological milestones.
- Kids aged 6-12 yrs old are 4x likely to visit a dentist than a pediatrician
- Topics include:
 - Oral/Dental development and growth
 - Oral Hygiene Instruction (OHI)
 - Diet and Nutrition
 - Habits (non-nutritive sucking)
 - Injury Prevention

Oral Development and Growth

- Regardless of pediatric or adult dentistry, a *good* dental home includes discussion of expectations
- Parents will expect/have questions about upcoming changes
- Baby teeth erupt when they're ready to erupt
 - Some kiddos will get their teeth faster, some will get them slower
 - The sequences are parallel: first to come in, first to go, etc.
- Parents like asking about ortho
- Timeline of various restorative procedures
 - Ex: How long do I need a space maintainer?

Health Considerations

- Prior to any assessment, patient health should always be evaluated
 - Consults are always key!
- Identifying the patient ASA classification is essential for advanced behavior management
- Airway in particular important in peds because adult emergencies usually result in cardiovascular incidents, children are typically **pulmonary**

OHI Distinctions

- Soft-bristled brushes only!
- Electric toothbrushes not recommended for <3 yrs of age
- Children **SHOULD** use a fluoridated toothpaste:
 - <3 yrs of age: 0.1 mg (**rice-grain or smear** amount)
 - 3-7 yrs of age: 0.25 mg (**pea-sized** amount)

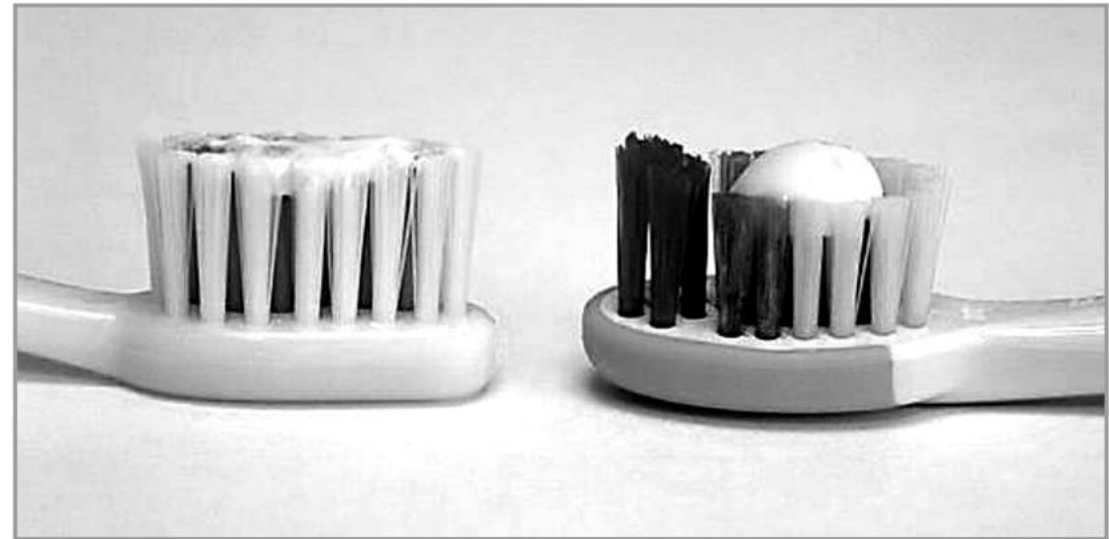


Figure. Comparison of a smear (left) with a pea-sized (right) amount of toothpaste.

OHI Distinction

- Brushing: time spent brushing is better than technique
 - 2 minutes is the recommended time
- Parents should assist with brushing and flossing until the age of 7 **or** when kids are able to tie their own shoelaces
- Type of toothpaste won't matter so long as its fluoridated



Night Time Feeding

- Recall from the Caries Risk Assessment that **bedtime use of the bottle results in high caries risk.**
- Salivary flow is diminished at nighttime and protective factors are lost.
- Infants (although some adults too) are constantly coating their teeth with lactose (present in breast milk, cow's milk, and even formula) which is a carbohydrate.
- Parents should be encouraged to **either brush the teeth after feeding or if not possible, to at least wipe the teeth with a wet cloth.**
 - Gradual dilution of bottle's contents also viable option

Diet and Nutrition

- The Caries Risk Assessment Form indicates children who snack **>3 times a day between meals** are at a **high risk**.
- Children in particular enjoy snacks and many enjoy treats (grandparents, daycares, schools are prime culprits)
- Frequency of carbohydrate exposure and meals increase caries risk.
- Advise parents to reduce frequency of snacking and try to have sweet treats as part of a meal to minimize dental damage.

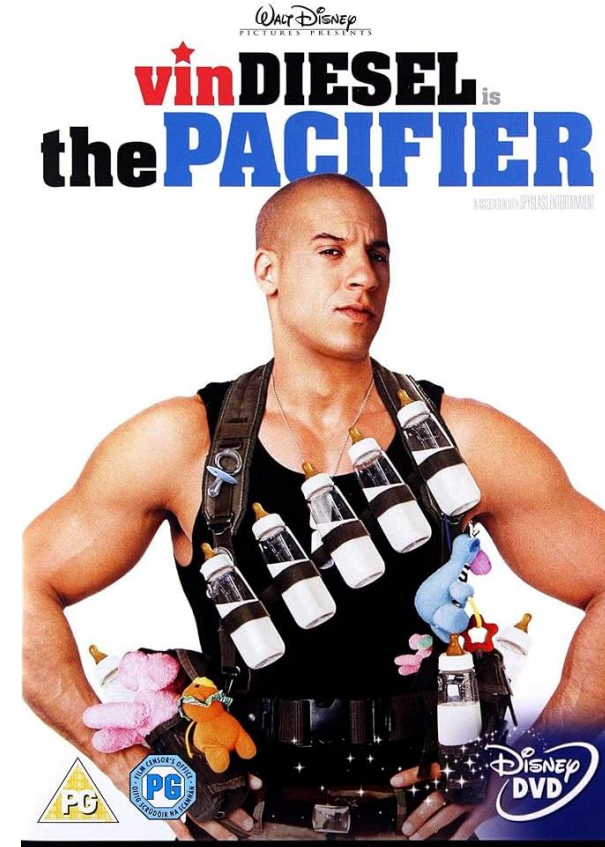
Sugar



[MerseySide](#)

Habits/Non-nutritive Sucking

- Non-nutritive Sucking
 - Thumbs, pacifier, blanket
- Nail Biting
- These are usually **soothing** behaviors and can persist
- Causes orthodontic issues
- Most kids (~60-65%) will quit on their own by the age of 3yrs



Injury Prevention

- Big part of growing up: scrapes and bruises
- Will discuss more in trauma lectures
- General info: kids (typically boys) are highest risk for dental injuries at ages 2-3 yrs
 - People with history of dental trauma are at risk for more trauma
 - 6-7 yr old kids at risk if they play contact sports! Recommend a mouthguard!

Walking Through Anticipatory Guidance

- Effective anticipatory guidance is age-appropriate and concise
- For learning purposes, I divided the content into three life stages: infancy, childhood, and adolescence.
- Remember: Frankl Score is assigned based on context!
 - All infants are by default a Frankl 2, specifically labeled as "Pre-Cooperative"

Infancy (0-3 yrs)

- Establish the dental home
- Is this a first-time parent? Have they or their child ever been to a pediatric dentist?
- Prophylaxis (with a toothbrush)
 - What about brushing at home?
- Radiographs only for emergencies
- Primary tooth eruption sequence/timing
 - Symptoms of teething: Soreness, irritability, drooling, chewing on things



Knee-to-Knee Exam



- Most infants cannot tolerate traditional exam settings
- Knee-to-Knee exam places patient's legs towards parents who will help hold the hands
- Useful time to also demonstrate a strategy for brushing at home if child does not like brushing

Childhood (3-12 yrs)

- Mixed dentition
 - Tooth eruption
 - Early ortho considerations
- Oral habits cont'd
- Sports
 - Age of 7 – recommend mouth guard (permanent anteriors at risk)
- Brushing Guidelines
 - Recommendation is for kids to get assistance with brushing until the age of 7 or if they can tie their own shoelaces

Adolescence

- Late-mixed dentition – talk about changes, ortho, wisdom teeth, etc.
- Sports
- Puberty and Hormonal Changes
 - Tobacco Cessation
 - Drugs and alcohol
 - Sexual/mucosally transmitted diseases
- Teenage Apathy + Mental health issues
 - Medical history will likely change!

Vaping



- Fairly new development
- Nicotine affects adolescent brain development (CDC)
- Adverse lung and cardiovascular effects
- Long-term usage unknown

Questions?